Revision Date:
June 1, 2024

Background:
State regulations require children under the age of six in the Assistance Unit (AU) to have received age-appropriate immunizations.

Purpose:
The purpose of this section is to provide immunization requirements. This material revision is to renumber this section from CalWORKs Program Guide (CPG) 42-100.J to CPG 42-100.C. This section is also being revised for Sunset Date review. No policy or procedure changes have been made. Section CPG 42-100.J becomes obsolete with the issuance of this revision.

Policy:
Informing Requirements
Customers will be informed of the following:
- Their obligation to secure immunizations for all children in the AU under the age of six, and the penalty for failure to comply.
- The age-appropriate immunizations.
- Their right to request an exemption due to their personal/religious beliefs, or for medical reasons.
- Their right to request an evaluation for good cause.
- How to obtain immunizations through a fee-for-service provider that accepts Medi-Cal, a Medi-Cal managed care plan, a county public health clinic, or any other sources available to the county.

Customers will be provided the above information at application, annual redetermination, and when adding a child under the age of six to the AU. The below forms will be provided:
- CW 101 - CalWORKs Immunization Rules Form
- CW 2209 - Immunization Good Cause Request Form

The forms are also included in the CalWORKs application/redetermination form packets.

Age Appropriate Immunizations
Age appropriate immunizations are those recommended by the Advisory Committee on Immunization Practices, the American Academy of Pediatrics, and the American Academy of Family Physicians.

Immunizations currently recommended for children under the age of six are:

Type of Immunization	Dose	Recommended at Age
Polio (OPV, TOPV, IPV, Sabin, Salk)	1st 2nd 3rd 4th	2 months 4 months 6-18 months Before starting school (4-6 years)
Diphtheria, Tetanus, Pertussis (DTP, DTaP, DT)	1st 2nd 3rd	2 months 4 months 6 months

Type of Immunization	Dose	Recommended at Age
	4th 5th	15-18 months Before starting school (4-6 years)
Kinrix Combination Vaccine DTaP and IPV combined in a single shot	Booster	4-6 years of age as a booster dose of DTaP, and IPV before they start kindergarten to protect them against Diphtheria, Tetanus, Pertussis, and Polio
Measles, Mumps, Rubella (MMR)	1st 2nd	12-15 month Before starting school (4-6 years)
Varicella Virus Vaccine (VAR, VZV, chickenpox)	1st	12-18 months Only required for vulnerable children (children who have not already had chickenpox)
Hepatitis B	1st 2nd 3rd	At birth – 3 months 1-5 months 6-18 months
Hemophilus influenzae Type b (Hib)	1st 2nd 3rd 3rd or 4th	2 months 4 months 6 months (may not be required) 12-18 months (if any dose is given after 12 months, no further doses are needed)
Pneumococcal	1st 2nd 3rd 4th	2 months 4 months 6 months 12-15 months

Children Who Have Not Received Any Immunization In The First Year Of Life

The following are immunizations recommended for children who have not received any immunizations in the first year of life:

Type of Immunization	1st Visit	2nd Visit (1-2 months after 1st visit)	3rd Visit (1-2 months after 2nd visit)	4th Visit (6 months after 3rd visit)
DTaP (DTP)	X	X	X	X
Hepatitis B	X	X		X
Hib	X	X		
MMR	X			
Polio (OPV, TOPV, IPV, Sabin, Salk)	X		X	
Varicella (VAR, VZV)	X	X		

Note: A health care provider will determine appropriate immunizations when some, but not all, were received during the first year after they were born.

Verification

The California Immunization Card (yellow card) is required to verify immunizations at application, redetermination, and when adding a child under the age of six to the AU. Verification is not required after the child receives all age-appropriate immunizations, is enrolled in school, or reaches the age of six.

If the yellow card is not available, any documentation completed and signed, may also be accepted to verify immunizations:

- A medical provider (physician, authorized member of physician's staff, public health department, etc.).
- A public agency which requires age-appropriate immunizations (local school district, the Head Start Program, licensed day care center, etc.).

Staff are required to assist customers in obtaining necessary verification. This includes clearing the California Immunization Registry (CAIR2) San Diego, to search for the pending verification.

When the immunization verification does not reflect age-appropriate immunizations:

- Customers will be provided with immunization referral information.
- The customer will be asked to take the child for immunizations.
- A CW 2200 Request for Verification checklist will be provided to the customer indicating the due date.

Timeframes

Immunization verification must be provided as follows:

- Applicant:
  - If applying for CalWORKs and Medi-Cal simultaneously - within 30 days from the date eligibility for Medi-Cal is granted (normally the same date CalWORKs is granted).
  - If applying for CalWORKs and already receiving Medi-Cal benefits - within 45 days from the CalWORKs application date.
- Recipient:
  - Within 45 days from the annual redetermination date.
- Adding a Child:
  - Follow the applicant time frames.
- Inter-county transfer cases:
  - Not required if the first county has determined the immunizations/verification to be adequate.

Exemptions

The immunization requirement does not apply when:

- The child cannot be immunized for medical reasons. A doctor/medical provider's written/signed statement describing the type and duration of the medical condition is required.
- An affidavit indicates that the immunization requirement is contrary to the applicant/recipient's religious or personal beliefs.

The CW 2209 form may be used to verify an exemption.

Good Cause

Customers may use a CW 2209 form to explain why their children's immunizations are not up-to-date. Customers are also allowed to verbally inform the Human Services Specialist of their good cause request. Making a verbal request is the same as completing the CW 2209 form. The verbal request and required information must be recorded in case comments.

Good cause for failure to submit verification includes:

- Lack of reasonable access to immunization services:
  - The child does not currently have Medi-Cal.
  - There is no nearby public clinic which offers free immunizations.
  - The family does not have adequate transportation.
- The child is too sick to receive immunizations:
  - The customer or the child was sick and could not go to the doctor.
- The customer could not get a timely appointment with the doctor.
- The immunization the child needed is unavailable.
- The records do not correctly show all the immunizations the children received, and the customer is trying to correct the records.
- There are language barriers.
- Domestic violence – if the abuse occurred in the past, the issue causing the non-cooperation or inability to comply must be related to the current situation.
- A good faith effort has been made to cooperate with requirement.
  - A child is considered to have received age-appropriate immunizations when the customer has made a good faith effort to begin immunizations for the child, but the series cannot be completed at the time of verification due to spacing requirements between the doses in the series.

In these instances, a penalty will not be imposed. The customer will be allowed an additional 30 days to submit immunization verification. Customer will be assisted as needed in obtaining verification of immunizations.

Failure to Cooperate

When an AU fails to provide the required immunization verification, determine whether good cause exists:

- If good cause exists, 30 days will be allowed to provide the verification as specified in the Good Cause section above.
- If no good cause exists:
  - The customer is considered non-cooperative with the immunization requirement.
  - If two parents are in the AU, both will have the penalty applied.
  - The penalized customer's needs are not considered for both financial eligibility and grant computation.
  - Any non-exempt income the penalized customer receives is counted in the family's income calculation.
  - In a minor parent case, the aided senior parent is considered the responsible caretaker relative and is therefore penalized if age-appropriate immunizations are not verified for the minor parent's child.

When there is a break-in-aid and the penalized customer reapplies, the penalty remains unless any of the criteria described under the Removing a Penalty section is met.

Notice of Action (NOA)
Use M40-105C NOA to:

- Specify which child is not current in their immunization records or lacks proof of up-to-date immunizations.
- List possible good cause reasons.
- Explain why a penalty will apply.
- Tell customers how, and when, cash aid would be restored to the AU.

Provide a CW 2209 form together with NOAs pertaining to grant changes due to the failure to meet immunization requirements.

Removing a Penalty
When it is determined that the penalty can be removed, the penalized customer will be added back to the AU:

- Effective the first of the following month in which any of the following situation occurs:
  - Documentation is obtained verifying all age-appropriate immunizations have been received by the child.
  - An exemption, or good cause, is met.
- Effective the first day of the month of the child's sixth birthday
  - Example: if the child's sixth birthday is June 5, 2024, the penalty ends May 31, 2024, and aiding the parent(s) as of June 1, 2024.

Note: The penalty must not be removed if verification is still needed for other children in the AU, for whom the penalty is imposed, and exemption/good cause criteria are not met.

Procedure:
Refer to the following materials, located in Eligibility Essentials, for additional information:

- Processing Guide 42-100.C1 Immunization: Provides immunization procedures.
- Desk Aid – Vaccine Acronyms and Abbreviations: Chart may be used as reference.
- Desk Aid – Immunization Schedule: Assists staff review the immunizations verification to determine if the child has received age-appropriate immunizations and answer CalSAWS accordingly.

Impacts:
None.

References:

- EAS 40-105.4
- ACL No. 17-87, 18-34

Sunset Date:
This policy will be reviewed for continuance by June 30, 2027.

Approval for Release:



Rick Wanne, Director
Self-Sufficiency Services